

Nothing Phone 3

A phone designed to stand out

The Nothing Phone 3 is a bit like a third album from a band that's done two solid records and is now figuring out whether to go experimental or mainstream. And to be honest, Carl Pei's latest feels like both. After living with the Phone 3 for a while, I can tell you this, it's not chasing trends, it's refining its own.

In 2025, when every phone starts looking like a glorified reference render, the Phone 3 is here to make a point. That design still matters. That software can feel fun. You don't have to pick between serious and playful. It's got all the quirks you expect in the Nothing DNA, a new dot-matrix LED instead of Glyph lights, but also the polish of a brand that's starting to mature. Nothing calls it their first flagship and even though you're paying a premium for nothing, is it a flagship even?

DESIGN

There's no polite way to put it, the Nothing Phone 3 still looks like no other phone on the market. And that's either a bold flex or a red flag, depending on who you ask. The transparent back is still here, but it's more sculpted now. It leans into asymmetry with curves and discs that feel intentional, almost like industrial art. This isn't a design meant to blend in. It's divisive, polarising, and that's kind of the point. Some will call it futuristic minimalism; others will say it looks like a sci-fi Lego kit.

All the elements have been arranged in a new three-column grid and the Glyph lights have been revamped to a "Glyph Matrix" LED array that's made up of 489 individually addressable LEDs that form a sort of dot-matrix display right on the back of the phone.

It can show you who's calling with a pixelated avatar, light up with app-specific icons, or act as a visual volume bar,

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timer, or flashlight. Paired with the new Glyph Button, the entire setup becomes this low-key, screenless interface for quick interactions. The red recording button has been carried on from the Phone 2 and gives off a subtle red blink that activates while capturing

video or using the recorder.

Someone at Nothing probably also agonised over the 1.87mm bezels, which are symmetrical and slimmer than before, but couldn't salvage the camera placement. Fun tidbit: the case that Nothing provides in the box has as many as 12 cutouts for different buttons, sensors and cameras. Anyway, the whole package is IP68-rated, with Gorilla Glass on both sides and a recycled aluminium frame sandwiched in between. At 218g it's not exactly lightweight, but it's the kind of heft that makes the phone feel planted and premium.

DISPLAY

The Nothing Phone 3 comes equipped

with a 6.67-inch flexible AMOLED panel that, on first impressions, delivers a bold and beautiful viewing experience. It combines a sharp 2800 x 1260 pixels resolution with HDR10+ support, a 10-bit colour depth, and a peak refresh rate of 120Hz, all housed within ultra-slim 1.87mm symmetrical bezels that add to its premium visual identity. Beneath the surface, there are some trade-offs worth understanding.

In real-world usage, the display is impressively bright and touch responsiveness is excellent. We recorded a manual peak brightness of 1370 nits, with automatic HDR peaks reaching 2720 nits, which puts it among the brightest panels in its segment.

Though, colour accuracy, based on our Calman tests, is solid but not industry-leading. In the Natural profile, the display returned an average deltaE of 2.1 and a maximum of 5.8, which is within acceptable bounds for most users but just outside what colour professionals might demand. The grayscale performance showed a slightly cooler white point (~6862K), and an average grayscale deltaE of 3.7, which is decent for daily media consumption but not perfectly neutral. The colour gamut coverage came in at 98% sRGB, with strong contrast and vivid colour reproduction. These figures won't disappoint in real-world use, but trained eyes may spot the occasional inaccuracy.

One important detail: this is an LTPS panel, not LTPO. The latter, typically seen in flagship phones (the same ones Nothing wants to be equated with), can dynamically adjust their refresh rate all the way down to 1Hz depending on content. That helps conserve battery, for instance, when reading a static page or displaying an always-on clock. LTPS, on the other hand, lacks that level of variable refresh scaling.

CAMERAS

The Nothing Phone 3 brings four 50MP sensors aiming to prove that good photography isn't just for phones with a "Pro Max" suffix. But while the spec